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NEWSPAPER

16th April, 2018

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

16th WEEK



SYRIA CRISIS & FAULT LINES

UPSC CSE
– GS II

GS II ... Effect of Policies and Politics of Developed and Developing Countries on India's Interests.



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... DISCUSSION

16th APRIL, 2018

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1

War for war

With missile strikes, the United States has irresponsibly escalated the Syrian conflict

By launching a missile attack on Syria, U.S. President Donald Trump has made good on his threat to use force if chemical weapons are used in the civil war-stricken country, but he has also escalated the devastating, multi-sided conflict. This is the second time Mr. Trump has ordered a missile attack on Syria. Last year, after a chemical attack in Idlib province, the U.S. fired 59 cruise missiles at an airbase of President Bashar al-Assad. This time, after a suspected chemical attack in Douma near Damascus, the U.K. and France joined hands with the U.S. to punish Mr. Assad's regime. On Friday night, over 100 missiles targeted three regime facilities; with this, the Pentagon said, Syria's chemical weapons programme has been gutted. While the use of chemical agents against civilians cannot and must not go unpunished, the manner in which the U.S. and its allies have acted raises serious questions. The U.S. undertook the strike before the Organisation for the Prohibition of Chemical Weapons even began its investigation in Douma to ascertain if chemical weapons had in fact been used. It should have waited till the inter-governmental watchdog completed its investigation and then presented the case for action in the UN Security Council with requisite evidence. By acting merely on the basis of inputs from their intelligence agencies, the U.S.-led alliance flouted international law.

It is also doubtful if Mr. Trump's "mission accomplished" bravado is justified. The fact that a provocation was perceived for a second strike within a year suggests that the first one failed to deter the Assad regime. On the other hand, Mr. Trump has dragged the U.S. deeper into the Syrian civil war. If there is a future chemical attack, either by Mr. Assad or by his rivals, the U.S. will be forced to act again, perhaps more harshly. Worryingly, every time the U.S. bombs Syria, the chances of a military confrontation in the country between the U.S. and Russia heightens, given that Moscow remains firmly behind Mr. Assad. What Syrians need is not more bombs and missiles, but an end to the war, which has killed at least 400,000 people in seven years. There is no dispute that Mr. Assad is presiding over a monstrous military machine that has used brute force against his own people. But the ground reality in Syria is so complex that a sudden collapse of the regime would push the country and the millions who live in relative stability in regime-held territories into further misery. That is the last thing anyone wants. The focus of the West needs to shift from unilateral military action to aggressive multi-lateral diplomacy to find an immediate end to violence and then a long-lasting political solution. For that, the U.S. and Russia have to work together under a UN mandate. There is no other path to peace in Syria.

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

16th April, 2018

A CONTINUING TRAGEDY

Strikes on Syria raise questions of legitimacy of force, underline renewed great power rivalry, while a brutal civil war unfolds

AFTER THE UNITED States, Britain and France rained missiles on Syria over the weekend, questions about the legitimacy and effectiveness of the action have come to the fore. For the critics, the absence of prior approval by the United Nations Security Council reflects the growing Western disregard for international law. Supporters of the decision say Syrian President Bashar al-Assad's use of chemical weapons on his own citizens is outrageous. Severe punishment, they say, is necessary to deter the production and use of these outlawed weapons of mass destruction. Critics, however, point to the fact that the Western bombings took place before an international team of experts verified the allegations on the use of chemical weapons. Whatever the merits of these arguments, the nuances of international law and ethical considerations in the use of force — just cause, last resort, proportionality and high probability of success — have long ceased to be relevant in the Middle East. What seems to matter is only politics and power — international and domestic.

The Middle East in general and Syria in particular have become victims of renewed great power rivalry, intensifying regional conflict and the breakdown of the internal political order in many countries. It is not just the Western powers and Russia who are using military force to pursue their political objectives in the region. Regional actors like Iran, United Arab Emirates, Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Turkey and Israel are all deeply involved in Syria's brutal civil war. This new dynamic has cut across the traditional lines of the political divide in the Middle East. The UN Security Council's rejection of a Russian resolution condemning the Western bombing of Syria underlines the profound international divisions. Only China and Bolivia backed the Russian resolution, the US and its European allies voted against. The only Arab country currently on the Security Council, Kuwait, sided with the West. Four other developing countries abstained.

It could even be said that the Western bombing of Syria makes little material difference to the balance of power on the ground. Even as he claimed that the bombing was successful, US President Donald Trump is signalling that he has no intention to be drawn deeper into the Syrian conflict. He wants to bring home the 2,000-odd US troops currently in Syria. The Western use of force was carefully designed to avoid an escalation of the confrontation with Russia and Iran, the main military backers of Damascus. The attack, which avoided targeting the Syrian leadership and its military command, also underlines the fact that the West is no longer interested either in ousting Assad from power or joining Russia in imposing regional peace. On a seemingly winning track, Assad seems to have no incentive for internal reconciliation. The tragedy in Syria, then, will continue to unfold.



The Indian **EXPRESS**
JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

16th April, 2018



1 War for war: On U.S. strikes on Syria

With missile strikes, the United States has irresponsibly escalated the Syrian conflict.

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UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... Effect of Policies and Politics of Developed and Developing Countries on India's Interests.

IMPORTANT QUESTION

ESSAY/ MAINS / GD / INTERVIEWS

Clear fault lines are evident in the United Nations and it is becoming ineffective day-by-day and discuss with recent examples.



MIDDLE EAST

ARAB SPRING



1 Arab Spring was a revolutionary wave of **violent as well as non violent demonstrations**, protests, riots, coups and in some cases civil wars in some of the Arab countries

2 It all began on **17th December, 2010** in Tunisia

3 It lead to major insurgencies and civil wars in countries like **Libya, Syria, Yemen**

4 Governments were overthrown in **Tunisia, Egypt, Yemen, Libya**

5 It lead to major protests in countries like **Algeria, Sudan** as well as minor protests in countries like **Saudi Arabia**

WHAT ARE THE MAIN REASONS FOR ARAB SPRING?

- 1 The main reason is authoritarian regimes in most of the Arab countries
- 2 Human Rights Violation with little freedom in several countries
- 3 The advent of powerful social media led to protests on mass scale and youth were on to the streets
- 4 Political corruption in some of the regimes is one of the reasons
- 5 Unemployment also precipitated the anger among the youth
- 6 The sectarian divide among Shiites, Sunnis is another reason for violent protests and subsequent civil wars are supported by some countries based on sectarian affiliations

North
Atlantic
Ocean



TUNISIA

ALGERIA

LIBYA

EGYPT

SUDAN

CHAD

Niger

MALI

MAURITANIA



North
Atlantic
Ocean

LIBYA

ALGERIA

EGYPT

MAURITANIA

MALI

Niger

CHAD

NIGERIA

IVORY COAST

Ghana

Benin

Cameroon

Gulf of Guinea

REPUBLIC
OF THE CONGO

DR CONGO

UGANDA

KENYA

TANZANIA

CENTRAL
AFRICAN
REPUBLIC

SOUTH SUDAN

ETHIOPIA

SOMALIA

YEMEN

OMAN

SAUDI ARABIA

IRAQ

IRAN

SYRIA

TURKEY

Mediterranean Sea

Greece

Italy

Adriatic Sea

Ionian Sea

Black Sea

Caspian Sea

TURKMENISTAN

UZBEKISTAN

AFGHANISTAN





TURKEY

SYRIA

IRAQ

JORDAN

Cyprus

Lebanon

Damascus

Aleppo

Israel

KUWAIT

Mediterranean Sea

SYRIA CRISIS

- 1 In March 2011, some teenagers were arrested when they painted some revolutionary slogans in a school in Daara
- 2 Protestors took to the streets in a big way and police opened fire killing several people
- 3 More street protests followed and Government used force to control them and several civilians were killed
- 4 Rebel brigades were formed to control the cities, towns and the countryside by acquiring arms. Here the rivalry of the Shias, Sunnis precipitated the crisis
- 5 As Bashar al-Assad belongs to Shiite Alawite sect, he was supported indirectly by Iran and some of the towns have majority population of Sunnis and Rebels (sunni groups) are supported by Saudi Arabia and others.
- 6 The long border of Turkey with Syria was used as conduit to the Rebel forces for arranging arms and ammunition
- 7 Seeing the political vacuum, IS spread its tentacles not only in Syria but also in adjacent Iraq

SYRIA CRISIS

- 8 Another group Kurds hold onto their strong holds and hence Syria became battle ground among the Government forces, Rebels, Islamic state with Kurds maintaining their supremacy in their areas of dominance



VARIOUS GROUPS IN SYRIA



al-Nusra Front



Free Syrian Army



**National Coalition for Syrian
Revolutionary and Opposition Forces**



Islamic State of Iraq and Syria

There are several other splinter groups in addition to them !

LOOK AT THE STATE OF AFFAIRS IN SYRIA!

LIVE

GROUP - 1

PRESIDENT
SYRIA



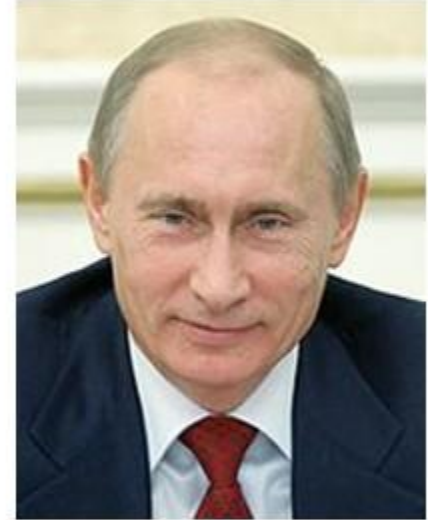
Bashar al-Assad
Syria President

SUPPORT FROM
IRAN



Hassan Rouhani
Iran President

SUPPORT FROM
RUSSIA



Vladimir Putin
Russian President



OTHERS LIKE HEZBOLLAH...

LOOK AT THE STATE OF AFFAIRS IN SYRIA!

LIVE

GROUP - 2

SUPPORT FROM
USA & WEST

SUPPORT FROM SAUDI
ARABIA & ITS GROUP

REBEL GROUPS IN
SYRIA



Donald Trump
President, USA



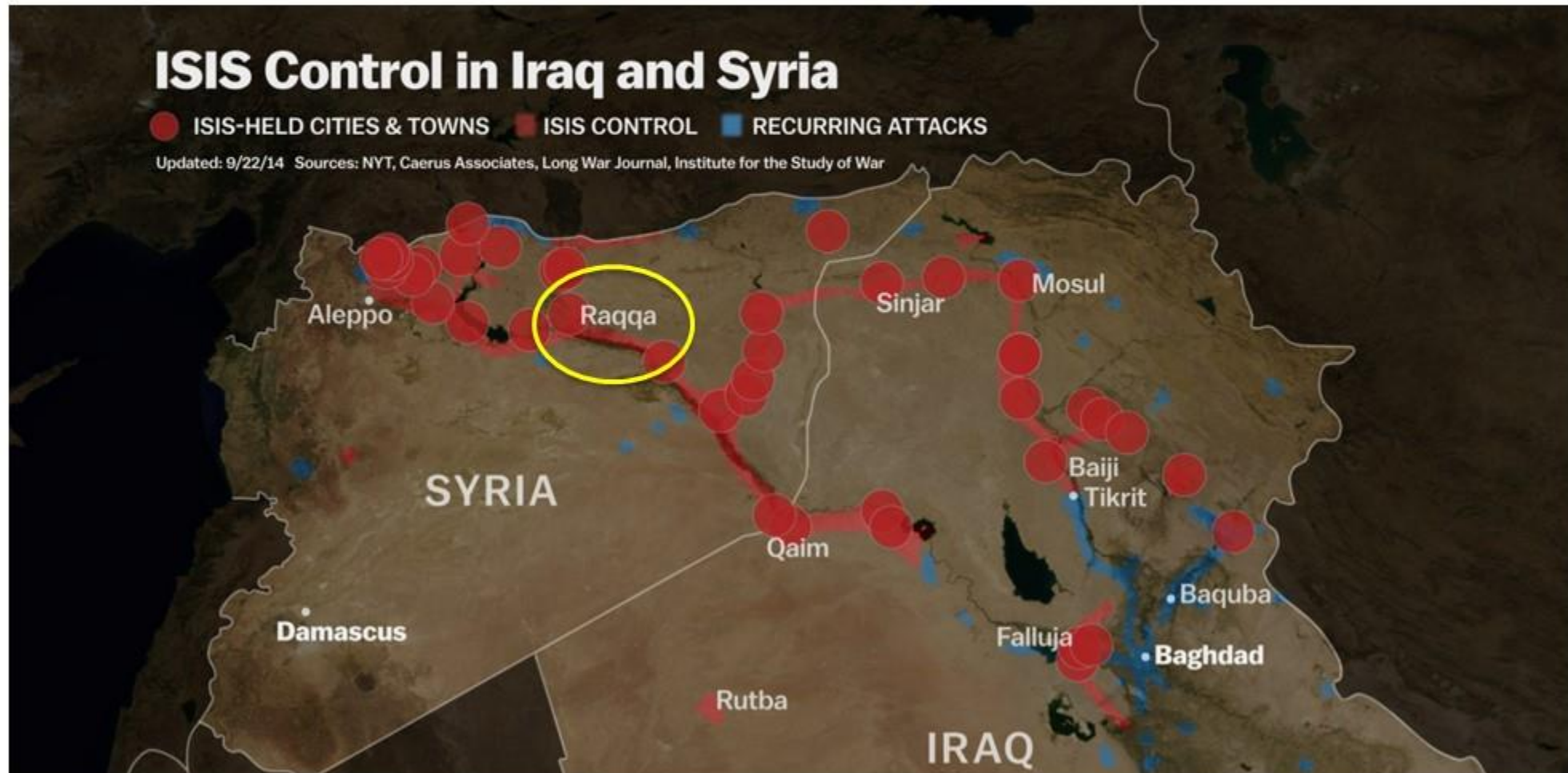
Salman
King, Saudi Arabia



OTHERS

GROUP - 3

IS by establishing self proclaimed Caliphate at Raqqa, Syria





NEWS REPORT

- U.S.A. President Donald Trump ordered a missile attack in Douma near Damascus.
- U.K. and France joined hands with U.S.A.
- This is after an chemical attack in Syria.
- Over 100 missiles targeted 3 regime facilities.

Pentagon said, Syria's chemical weapons programme has been gutted.

CONVENTIONAL WEAPONS



UNOG

THE UNITED NATIONS OFFICE AT GENEVA

- Sea & Land Mines
- Shells
- Rockets
- Missiles
- Cluster Bombs
- Incendiary Weapons
- Blinding Laser Weapons

1. Convention on Certain Conventional Weapons (CCW) or Inhumane Weapons Convention looks at the use.
2. Incendiary weapons are prohibited in civilian areas as per Protocol III of the Convention.

CONVENTIONAL WEAPONS

- Sea & Land Mines
- Shells
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- Blinding Laser Weapons

WEAPONS OF MASS DESTRUCTION

- Nuclear Weapons
- Biological Weapons
- Chemical Weapons
- Radiological Weapons

WHAT ABOUT CONVENTION ?



- OPCW implements the “Chemical Weapons Convention”
- Goal is World “Free of Chemical Weapons”
- Entered into force in 1997
- It has got 192 member states

4 MAIN GOALS

- Organisation for the Prohibition of Chemical Weapons (OPCW)
- Headquarters:
The Hague

- 1 Destroying all chemical weapons under International verification
- 2 Monitoring chemical industry to prevent re-emergence of new weapons
- 3 Protection to state parties against chemical threat
- 4 Fostering international cooperation for implementing the Convention



DID SYRIA SIGN THE CONVENTION?

- 1 Syria joined the Convention in 2013.
- 2 The Convention prohibits the production, possession and use of chemical weapons.
- 3 Syria was also subjected to additional duties contained in Security Council Resolution 2118, reinforcing these obligations and providing for the destruction of its chemical weapons stockpile.

The destruction of chemical weapons stockpile was achieved a year later by September, 2014.





CHARTER of THE UNITED NATIONS

AND STATUTE of THE
INTERNATIONAL COURT
OF JUSTICE



UN Security Council

WHAT THE UN CHARTER SAYS?

- 1** The UN Charter allows states to use force in self-defence.
- 2** It can also use force for the protection of populations threatened by extermination at the hands of their own Government.
- 3** The use of force for broader purposes of maintaining international security is also possible.

However, such action is subject to the requirement of mandate from the UN Security Council.



WHAT IS BEING HAPPENED DURING THE PAST 3 - 4 YEARS?

- 1 Since then, there are 40 recorded instances of chemical weapons use in Syria.
- 2 The Organization for the Prohibition of Chemical Weapons (OPCW) has got the ability to dispatch fact-finding missions to determine whether such weapons have actually been used.
- 3 A Special Joint Mechanism was set up by the OPCW and the Security Council, with a mandate to assign responsibility for such uses.

After the Special Joint Mechanism pointed finger at Assad Government, Russia vetoed its renewal.



UN Security Council

WHAT IS THE CONTENTION OF THE THREE COUNTRIES, WHICH LAUNCHED MISSILES?

- 1 The three countries argue that there is no prospect of obtaining a mandate from UN Security Council to confront chemical weapons use by Syria.
- 2 By striking Syria, the three countries says they have fulfilled an international public order function of defending the credibility of the prohibition of the use of chemical weapons.



It once again shows the ineffectiveness of the United Nations.

WHAT IS THE PRESENT DAY REALITY?

- 1 The Middle East in general and Syria in particular, have become victims of renewed great power rivalry, intensifying regional conflicts and breakdown of the internal political order is there in many countries.
- 2 It is not only the Western powers and Russia, who are using military force to pursue their political objectives, but Regional actors like Iran, U.A.E., Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Turkey and Israel are also deeply involved in Syria's brutal civil war.
- 3 Russian Resolution condemning the Western bombing of Syria got the support of only China and Bolivia and it indicates the severe fault lines in United Nations.



MIDDLE EAST

WE EXPRESS OUR SINCERE THANKS FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

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